David Jelke

Design Researcher / UX Designer
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Profile

Design researcher with experience in health systems and enterprise products, specializing in mixed-methods research, ethnography, and collaborative synthesis. Skilled at translating complex human behaviors and system dynamics into clear, actionable insights that guide product and organizational decision-making.

Experience

UX Designer / Design Researcher

Mayo Clinic Labs | Oct 2023 – Present

- Lead biweekly **product user group sessions** with lab technicians, facilitating open-ended conversations to solicit workflow pain points, surface unmet needs, and solicit feedback on prototypes
- Designed and executed 16 research projects spanning five enterprise healthcare products, crafting **discussion guides** and using mixed methods including **moderated interviews**, **usability testing**, **tree testing**, and **card sorts**.
- Crafted compelling research narratives, decks, and reports, presenting findings to cross-functional stakeholders and directly influencing product strategy and roadmaps.
- Built deep domain knowledge by completing an online **Harvard biochemistry course** this year to better understand lab medicine workflows and scientific constraints.
- Developed technical fluency through full-stack coursework (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, Node.js, Express, React) to collaborate more effectively with engineering and IT partners

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UX Designer

Northwestern Medicine | May 2022 – Aug 2023

- Conducted **21 in-depth stakeholder interviews** across clinical and operational roles to uncover workflow breakdowns and system-level bottlenecks in trauma care environments.
- Led **two onsite hospital interviews**, conducting fieldwork, ethnography, and in-depth interviews
- Led **two sessions with ER doctors, nurses, and staff** to rank and sort different concepts
- **Synthesized** qualitative findings into clear insights and opportunity frameworks that informed the design of an enterprise patient bed-tracking tool.

Teaching Assistant – Designing Your Life

Northwestern University | Jan 2022 – Mar 2023

- Served on the teaching staff for **four consecutive sections** of one of Northwestern's most popular courses, supporting 120 students across diverse majors.
- Facilitated design thinking workshops, reflective exercises, and group discussions, guiding participants through ambiguity, synthesis, and decision-making.
- Helped students apply human-centered methods to complex personal and professional challenges.

Design Researcher (Graduate Thesis)

Northwestern University | Aug 2022 – Mar 2023

- Independently scoped and executed a qualitative research study exploring unmet needs in **podcast discovery and e-reading behaviors**.
- Recruited and conducted **semi-structured interviews with 13 participants**, designing discussion guides and managing end-to-end fieldwork.
- Synthesized interview data into research insights and opportunity frameworks, connecting individual narratives to broader behavioral patterns.

Tech Reporter (Intern)

Breakfast Media | Jan 2020 – May 2020

- Researched and wrote **157 technology news articles**, including six feature stories.
- Developed strong storytelling, synthesis, and written communication skills through deadline-driven editorial work.

Education

Master of Science, Design Engineering
Northwestern University | 2021 – 2023

Bachelor of Arts, Neuroscience
Dartmouth College | 2015 – 2019

Research & Methods

- Mixed-methods research
- Qualitative interviewing & ethnography
- Live synthesis & sensemaking
- Research planning & discussion guide development
- Survey design & analysis (Qualtrics)
- Systems mapping & journey mapping
- Workshop facilitation & co-design

Technical & Data Fluency

- HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- SQL, Node.js, Express, React
- Data-informed analysis & prototyping

Tools

- Figma
- Adobe Creative Cloud
- WordPress

Emerging Interests

- Applied systems thinking in healthcare and complex organizations
- Human-centered approaches to data, AI, and enterprise tools